

A

Verb + noun suffix

Suffixes are used at the ends of words; they often tell you if a word is a noun, a verb, an adjective or an adverb. Two suffixes which form nouns from verbs are **-ion** and **-ment**.

verb	noun
invent [produce or design something completely new]	invention
discuss [talk about something seriously]	discussion
translate [change from one language to another]	translation
relax [rest, and feel calm and comfortable]	relaxation
improve [get better]	improvement
govern [control the affairs of a city or country]	government
manage [direct or control a business]	management
develop [grow or change and become more advanced]	development

His latest **invention** is a new board game.
Relaxation will help you to sleep better.
 We had a **discussion about** politics.

The **management** has to change.
 I need money for more **development**.
 We need an **improvement in** the weather.

B

Adjective + noun suffix

The suffixes **-ness** and **-ity** often form nouns from adjectives.

adjective	noun
weak (<i>opp</i> strong)	weakness
happy	happiness
ill [sick, not well]	illness
fit [in good condition, usually because of exercise]	fitness
stupid (<i>opp</i> intelligent, clever)	stupidity
popular [liked by a lot of people]	popularity
similar [almost the same; <i>opp</i> different]	similarity
able	ability (<i>opp</i> inability)

What is his main **weakness** as a manager?
 Snowboarding is growing in **popularity**.
 I'm frustrated by my **inability to** use computers.

Fortunately it wasn't a serious **illness**.
 There is a **similarity between** them.
 Her **happiness** is all that matters to me.

C

-er, -or and -ist

These suffixes can be added to nouns or verbs. They often describe people and jobs.

-er	-or	-ist
ballet dancer pop singer professional footballer	company director translator film actor	artist , e.g. Picasso economist scientist

Language help

Adding a suffix to a verb, adjective or noun may change the position of the main stress, e.g. re'lax – relax'ation, 'stupid – stu'pidity, eco'nomics – e'conomist.
 (The ' symbol is before the syllable with the main stress.)